
Bayesian Networks: Representation

CS5491: Artificial Intelligence
ZHICHAO LU

Content Credits: Prof. Wei's CS4486 Course
and Prof. Boddeti's AI Course



TODAY

Independence

Bayes Net Introduction



PROBABILISTIC MODELS

Models describe how (a portion of) the world works



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What do we do with probabilistic models?

- We (or our agents) need to reason about unknown variables, given evidence
- Example: explanation (diagnostic reasoning)
- Example: prediction (causal reasoning)
- Example: value of information



INDEPENDENCE



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$$\forall x, y : P(x, y) = P(x)P(y)$$



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Independence is a simplifying *modeling assumption*

- *Empirical* joint distributions: at best "close" to independence
- What could we assume for (Weather, Traffic, Cavity, Toothache)?



EXAMPLE: INDEPENDENCE

T	W	P
hot	sun	0.4
hot	rain	0.1
cold	sun	0.3
cold	rain	0.2



EXAMPLE: INDEPENDENCE

T	P
hot	0.5
cold	0.5

W	P
sun	0.6
rain	0.4

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N fair, independent coin flips:



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$$P(X_1)$$

H	0.5
T	0.5



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$P(X_1)$		$P(X_2)$		$\dots$		$P(X_n)$	
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T	0.5	T	0.5			T	0.5

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$P(X_1)$

H	0.5
T	0.5

$P(X_2)$

H	0.5
T	0.5

...

$P(X_n)$

H	0.5
T	0.5

$P(X_1, \dots, X_n)$

X_1	X_2	...	X_n	
H	H	...	H	
H	H	...	T	
⋮	⋮	⋮	⋮	
T	T	...	T	

CONDITIONAL INDEPENDENCE

$P(\text{Toothache}, \text{Cavity}, \text{Catch})$



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- $P(+catch | +toothache, +cavity) = P(+catch | +cavity)$



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- $P(catch | toothache, cavity) = P(catch | cavity)$



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Equivalent statements:

- $P(toothache | catch, cavity) = P(toothache | cavity)$
- $P(toothache, catch | cavity) = P(toothache | cavity)P(catch | cavity)$
- One can be derived from the other easily



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- iff:

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- or, equivalently, iff

$$\forall x, y, z : P(x | y, z) = P(x | z)$$



CONDITIONAL INDEPENDENCE

Example 1:

- T: Traffic
- U: Umbrella
- R: Raining



CONDITIONAL INDEPENDENCE

Example 1:

- T: Traffic
- U: Umbrella
- R: Raining

Example 2:

- F: Fire
- S: Smoke
- A: Alarm



CONDITIONAL INDEPENDENCE AND CHAIN RULE

Chain rule: $P(X_1, X_2, \dots, X_n) =$
 $P(X_1)P(X_2|X_1)P(X_3|X_2, X_1) \dots$



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$$P(T, R, U) = P(R)P(T|R)P(U|R, T)$$



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Bayes nets / graphical models help us express conditional independence assumptions



BAYES NET: BIG PICTURE



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Two problems with using full joint distribution tables as our probabilistic models:

- Unless there are only a few variables, the joint is WAY too big to represent explicitly
- Hard to learn (estimate) anything empirically about more than a few variables at a time



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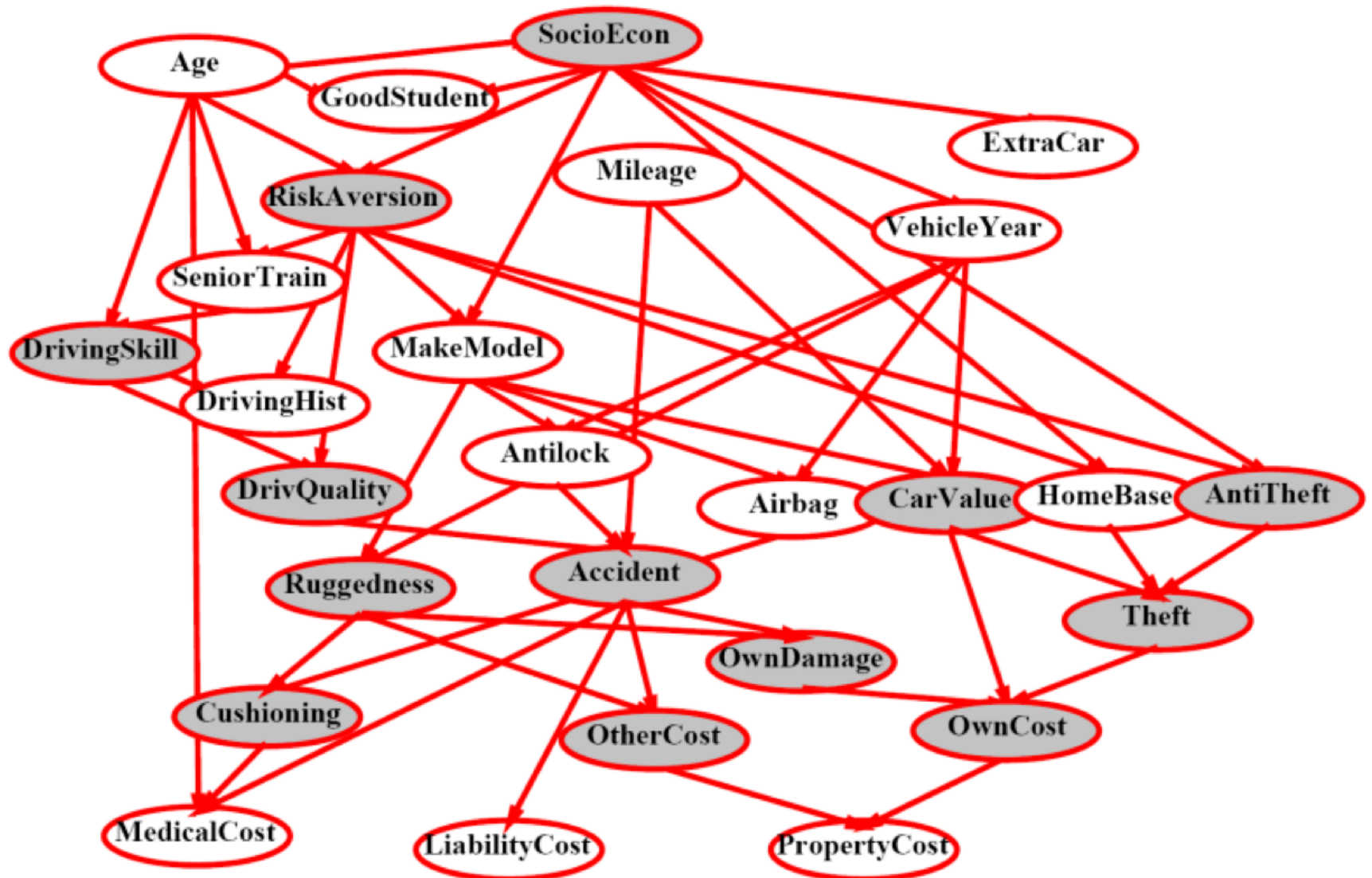
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Bayes nets: a technique for describing complex joint distributions (models) using simple, local distributions (conditional probabilities)

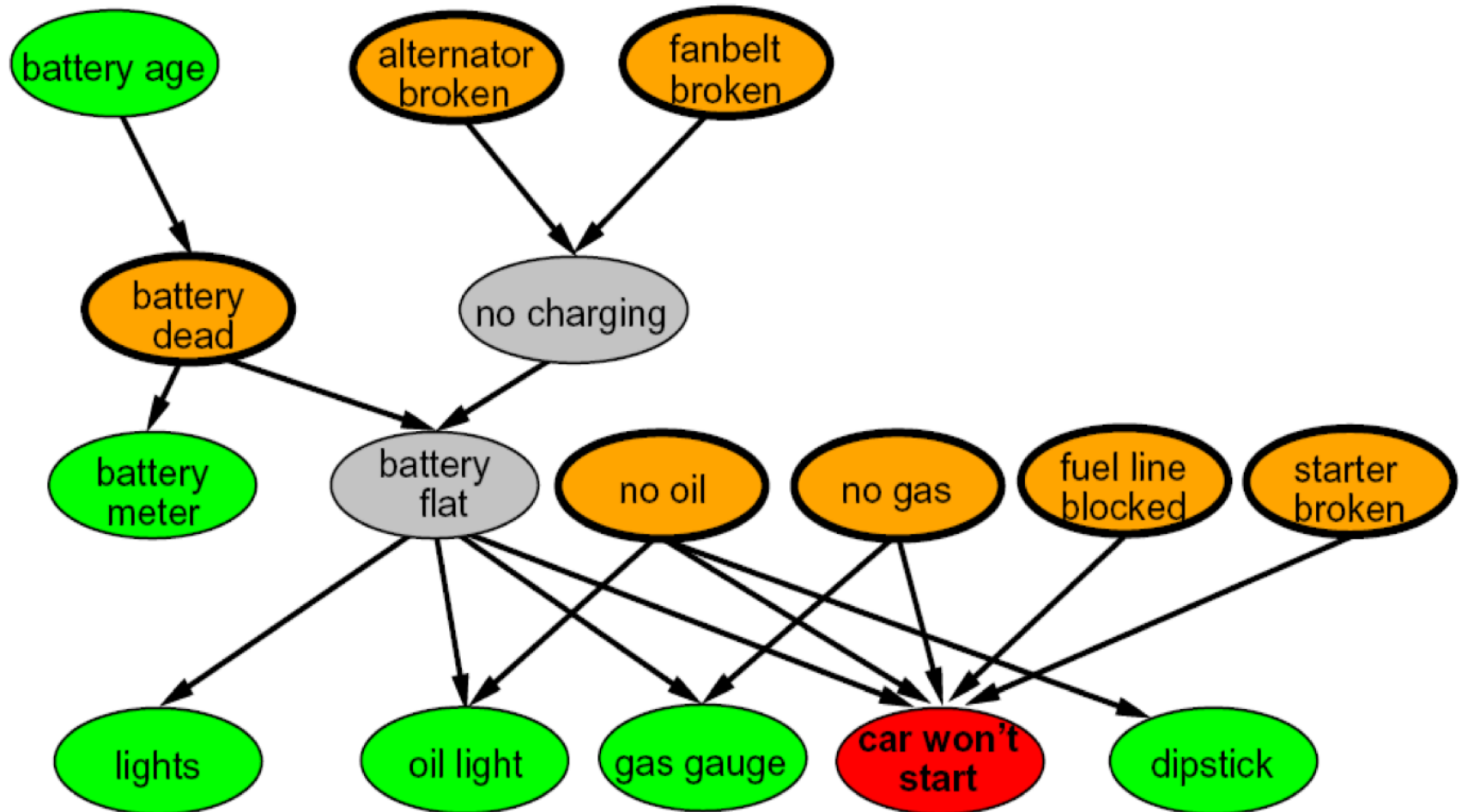
- More properly called **probabilistic graphical models**
- We describe how variables locally interact
- Local interactions chain together to give global, indirect interactions



EXAMPLE BAYES NET: INSURANCE



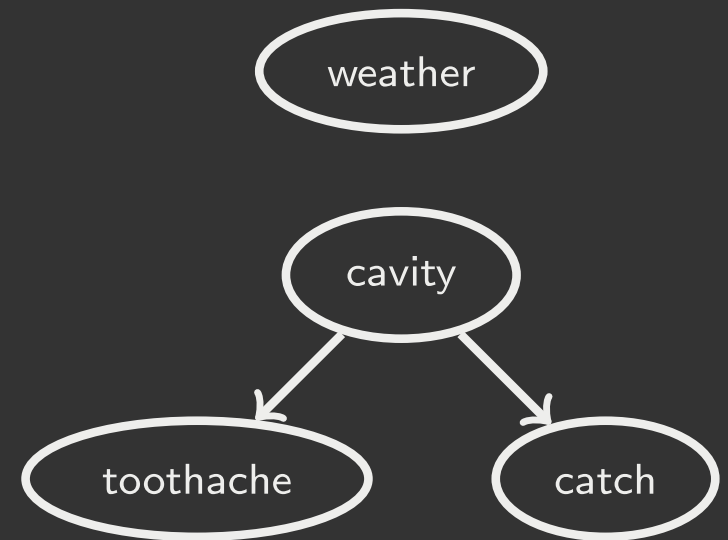
EXAMPLE BAYES NET: CAR



GRAPHICAL MODEL NOTATION

Nodes: variables (with domains)

- Can be assigned (observed) or unassigned (unobserved)



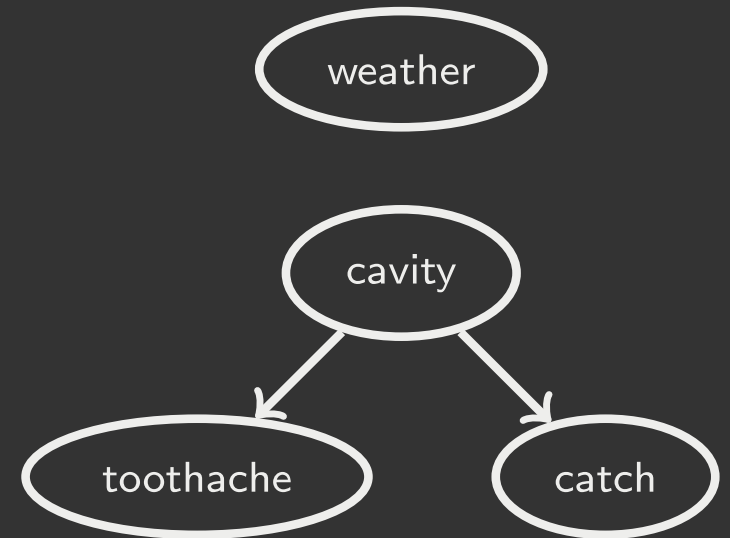
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- Similar to CSP constraints
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- Formally: encode conditional independence (more later)



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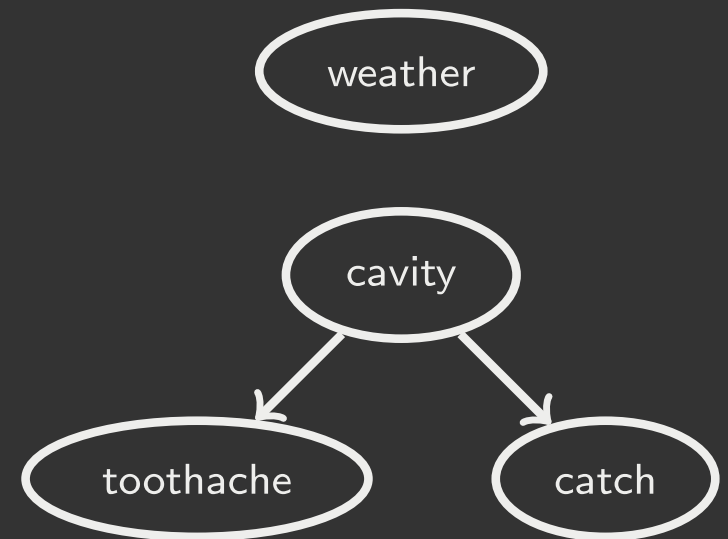
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For now: imagine that arrows mean direct causation (in general, they don't.)



EXAMPLE: COIN FLIPS

N independent coin flips



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No interactions between variables: **absolute independence**



EXAMPLE: TRAFFIC

Variables:

- R: it rains
- T: there is traffic



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Model 2: rain causes traffic



EXAMPLE: TRAFFIC

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Model 1: independence



Model 2: rain causes traffic



Why is an agent using model 2 better?



EXAMPLE: TRAFFIC II

How do we build a causal graphical model?

Variables:

- T: Traffic
- R: It rains
- L: Low pressure
- D: Roof drips
- B: Ballgame
- C: Cavity



EXAMPLE: ALARM NETWORK

How do we build a causal graphical model?

Variables:

- B: Burglary
- A: Alarm goes off
- M: Mary calls
- J: John calls
- E: Earthquake

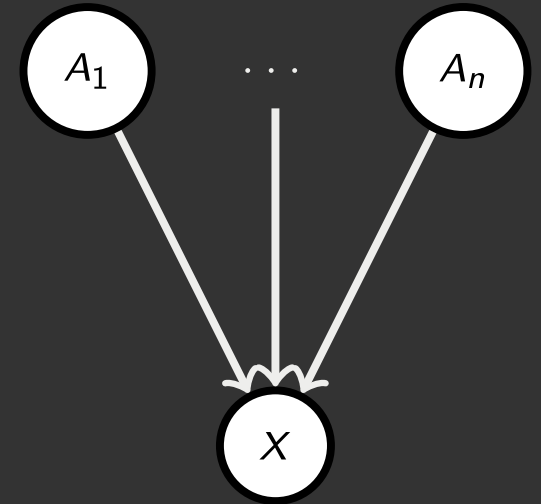


BAYES NET SEMANTICS



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A set of nodes, one per variable X

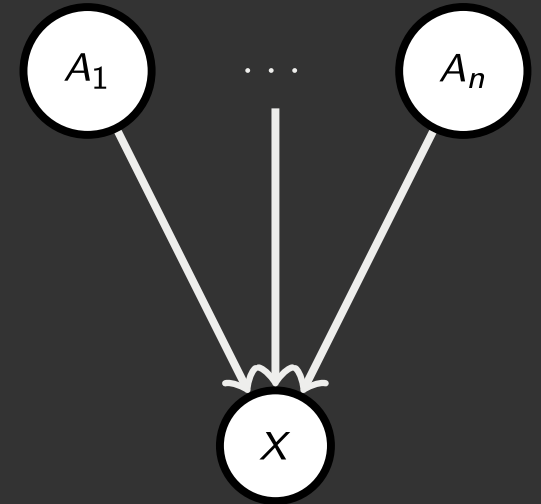


$$P(X|A_1, \dots, A_n)$$

BAYES NET SEMANTICS

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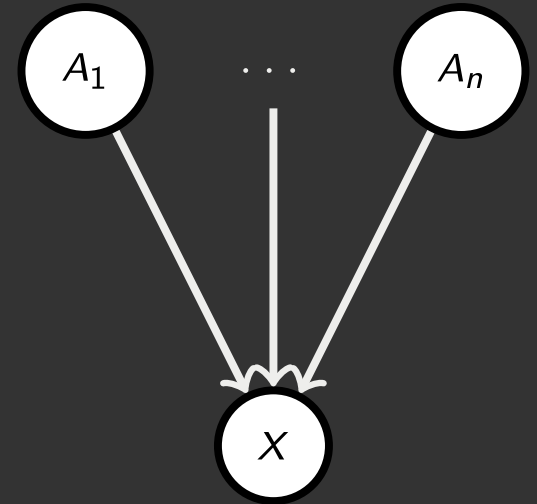
A set of nodes, one per variable $\mathcal{X}$

A directed, acyclic graph

A conditional distribution for each node

- A collection of distributions over $\mathcal{X}$, one for each combination of parents' values

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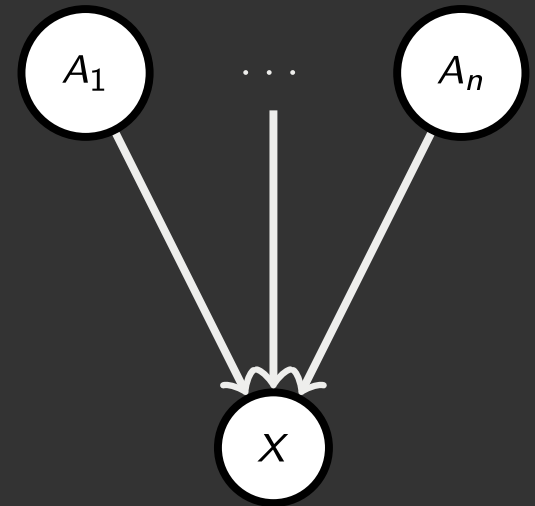
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- CPT: conditional probability table
- Description of a noisy "causal" process



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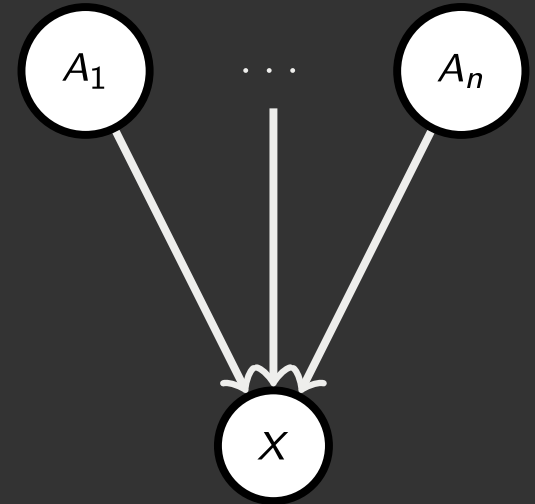
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A Bayes net = Topology (graph) + Local Conditional Probabilities



$$P(X|A_1, \dots, A_n)$$

PROBABILITIES IN BNS

Bayes nets **implicitly** encode joint distributions



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- To see what probability a BN gives to a full assignment, multiply all the relevant conditionals together:

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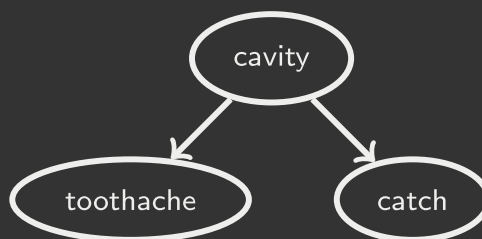
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- Example: $P(+cavity, +catch, -toothache)$



PROBABILITIES IN BNS

Why are we guaranteed that setting the following results in a proper joint distribution?

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Not every BN can represent every joint distribution

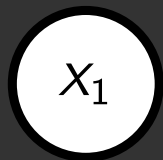
- The topology enforces certain conditional independencies



EXAMPLE: COIN FLIPS



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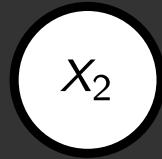
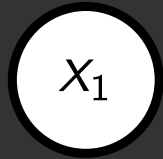


$P(X_1)$

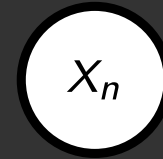
h	0.5
t	0.5



EXAMPLE: COIN FLIPS



...



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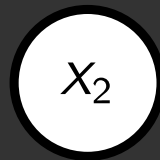
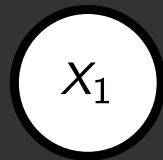
$P(X_2)$

h	0.5
t	0.5

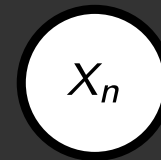
$P(X_n)$

h	0.5
t	0.5

EXAMPLE: COIN FLIPS



...



$P(X_1)$

h	0.5
t	0.5

$P(X_2)$

h	0.5
t	0.5

$P(X_n)$

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t	0.5

$$P(h, h, t, h) =$$

Only distributions whose variables are absolutely independent can be represented by a Bayes net with no arcs.

EXAMPLE: TRAFFIC



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$P(R)$

$+r$	$1/4$
$-r$	$3/4$

EXAMPLE: TRAFFIC



$P(R)$

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$P(T|R = +r)$

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$+t$	$1/2$
$-t$	$1/2$

$$P(+r, -t) =$$

EXAMPLE: TRAFFIC

Causal direction



	$P(T)$	$P(R T = +t)$	$P(R T = -t)$
$+r$	$1/4$	$3/4$	$1/2$
$-r$	$3/4$	$1/4$	$1/2$

$+r$	$+t$	$3/16$
$+r$	$-t$	$1/16$
$-r$	$+t$	$6/16$
$-r$	$-t$	$6/16$

EXAMPLE: REVERSE TRAFFIC

Reverse Causality?



	$P(T)$		$P(R T = +t)$		$P(R T = -t)$
$+t$	$9/16$	$+r$	$1/3$	$+r$	$1/7$
$-t$	$7/16$	$-r$	$2/3$	$-r$	$6/7$

$+r$	$+t$	$3/16$
$+r$	$-t$	$1/16$
$-r$	$+t$	$6/16$
$-r$	$-t$	$6/16$

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When Bayes nets reflect the true causal patterns:

- Often simpler (nodes have fewer parents)
- Often easier to think about
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- E.g. consider the variables *Traffic* and *Drips*
- End up with arrows that reflect correlation, not causation



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What do the arrows really mean?

- Topology may happen to encode causal structure
- **Topology really encodes conditional independence**

$$P(x_i | x_1, \dots, x_{i-1}) = P(x_i | \text{parents}(x_i))$$



BAYES NET

So far: how a Bayes net encodes a joint distribution



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Next: how to answer queries about that distribution

- Today:
 - First assembled BNs using an intuitive notion of conditional independence as causality
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- Main goal: answer queries about conditional independence and influence



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After that: how to answer numerical queries (inference)



Q & A



XKCD

